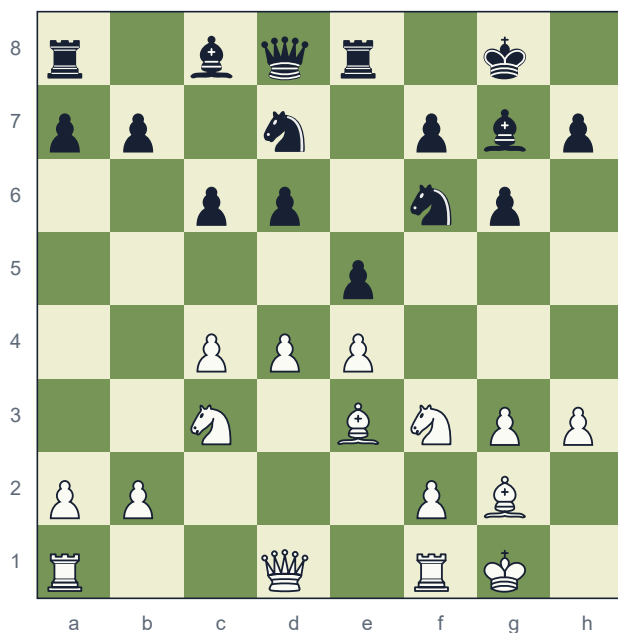


King's Indian: a fianchetto repertoire

1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3

YOUR REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use Bg2 and castling to build a resilient king position. Develop Nc3 and take e4 when the center is ready; then learn whether to close with d5 or keep the tension.



Main-line anchor - Black to move

THE PAWN STRUCTURE

Black concedes central space and strikes with ...e5 or ...c5. The g2 bishop helps defend your king and adds central pressure, but its diagonal can be blocked by your own pawns.

WHAT BLACK WANTS

Black seeks ...e5, ...c5, and sometimes a queenside ...a6/...b5 expansion. ...f5 becomes relevant only when the knight and pawn structure permit it.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. This is not the Mar del Plata race with an automatic white queenside attack and black kingside attack.
2. Keep the g2 bishop unless a concrete exchange is favorable.
3. Always inspect ...c5 before assuming you can close the center with d5.

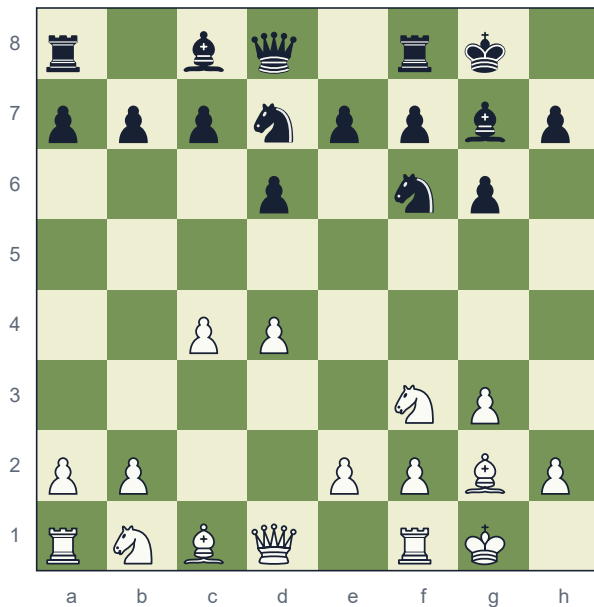
Line pages contain a selected opening anchor plus an illustrative checked continuation. They are not a forced script. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Classical fianchetto development

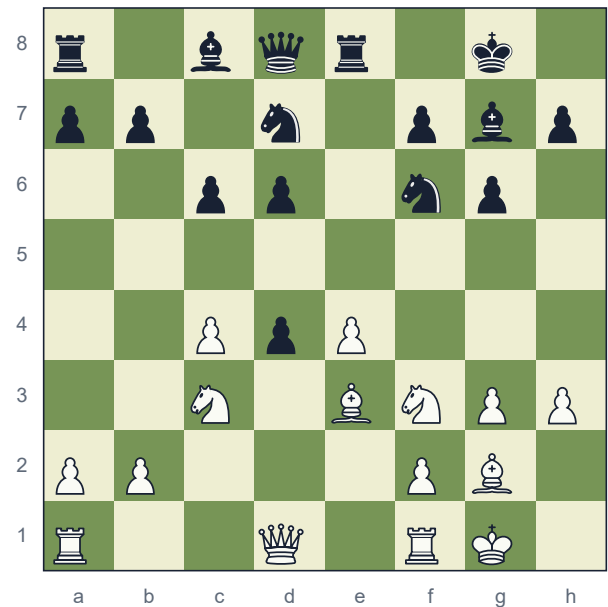
STUDY LINE 14-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. e4 c6 9. h3 Re8 10. Be3 exd4

Selected anchor ends with 10. Be3. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The center is supported by pieces before e4. h3 restricts ...Bg4 and gives the king position a little flexibility.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Choose Qc2, Re1 or d5 according to Black's regrouping. If the center closes, identify useful knight routes rather than launching pawns immediately.

WATCH FOR

A kingside pawn move can weaken the very squares your fianchetto is meant to protect.

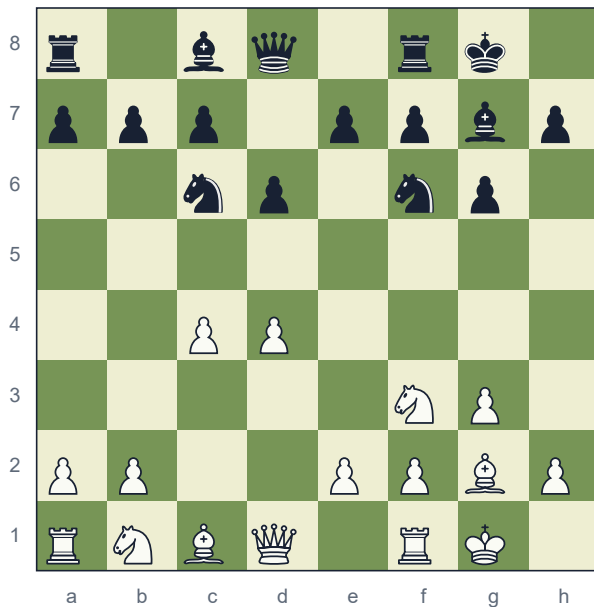
REMEMBER Build the center behind a secure king.

02 Panno: ...Nc6 and ...a6

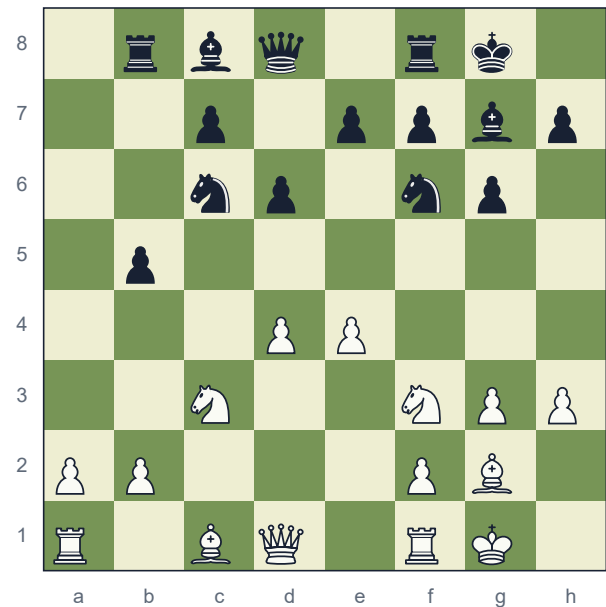
STUDY LINE 14-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nc6 7. Nc3 a6 8. h3 Rb8 9. e4 b5 10. cxb5 axb5

Selected anchor ends with 8... Rb8. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Black prepares queenside expansion. h3 is a useful waiting move but does not by itself stop ...b5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Consider a4 to restrain ...b5, or prepare e4 if the center is ready. Decide which plan fits Black's rook and knight placement.

WATCH FOR

Do not push a4 and assume all queenside threats have vanished; ...Na5 and ...c5 can create new play.

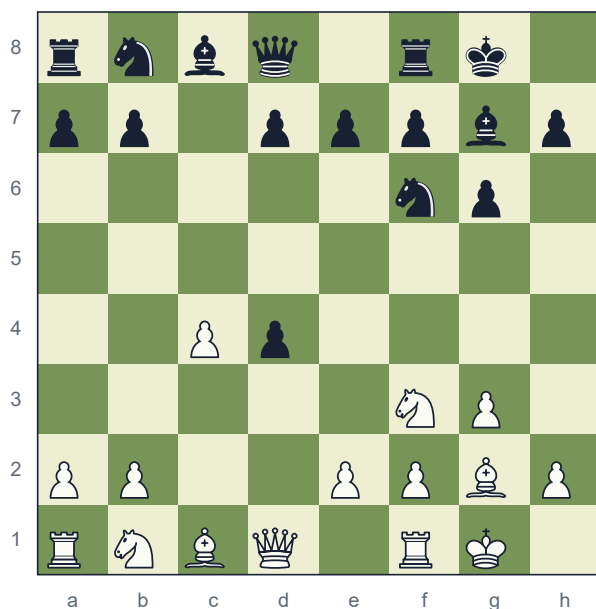
REMEMBER Read the purpose of ...Rb8 before choosing your plan.

03 The ...c5 structure

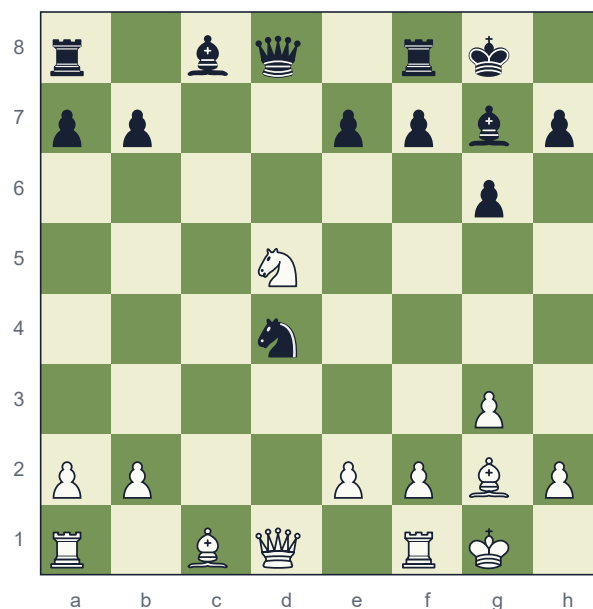
STUDY LINE 14-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 c5 6. O-O cxd4 7. Nxd4 Nc6 8. Nc3 d5 9. cxd5 Nxd5 10. Nxd5 Nxd4

Selected anchor ends with 7... Nc6. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The knight recapture keeps a healthy pawn structure and moves the game away from a locked center.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Nc3 and a useful bishop development complete your setup. Watch ...d5 as a freeing central break.

WATCH FOR

Do not play e4 without checking whether ...Nxe4 or ...d5 changes the tactical balance.

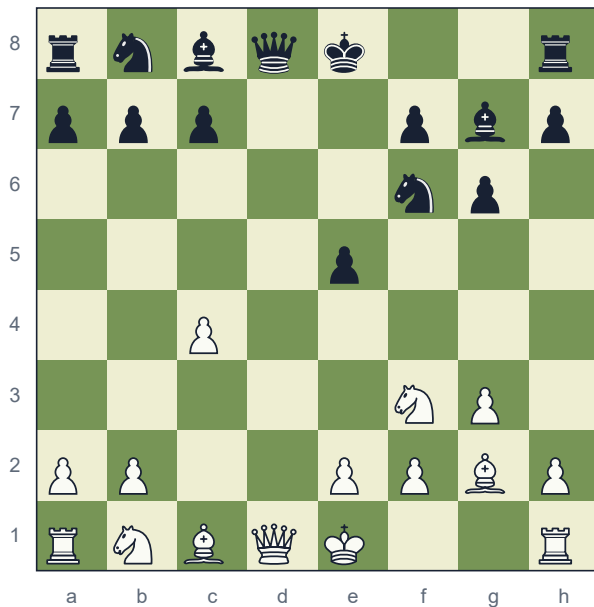
REMEMBER An open center rewards piece activity.

04 Black attacks the center before castling

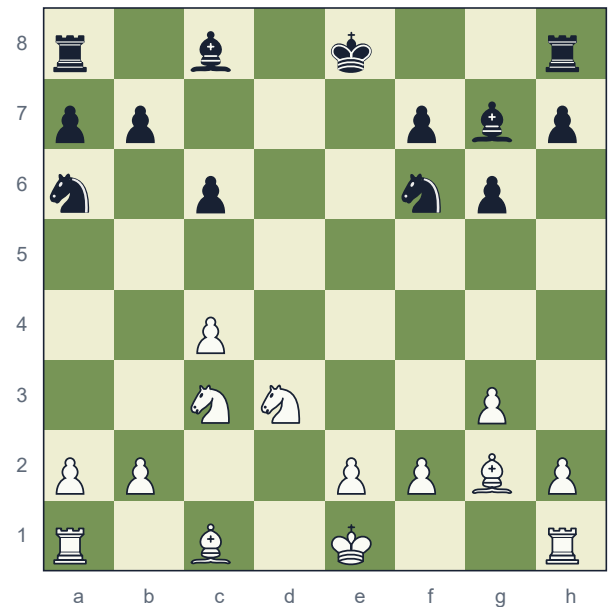
STUDY LINE 14-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 d6 5. Bg2 e5 6. dxe5 dxe5 7. Qxd8+ Kxd8 8. Nxe5 Ke8 9. Nc3 c6 10. Nd3 Na6

Selected anchor ends with 7... Kxd8. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

A queen trade is available when the d-file opens. It reduces king-attack risk but does not make Black's king permanently weak in an endgame.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

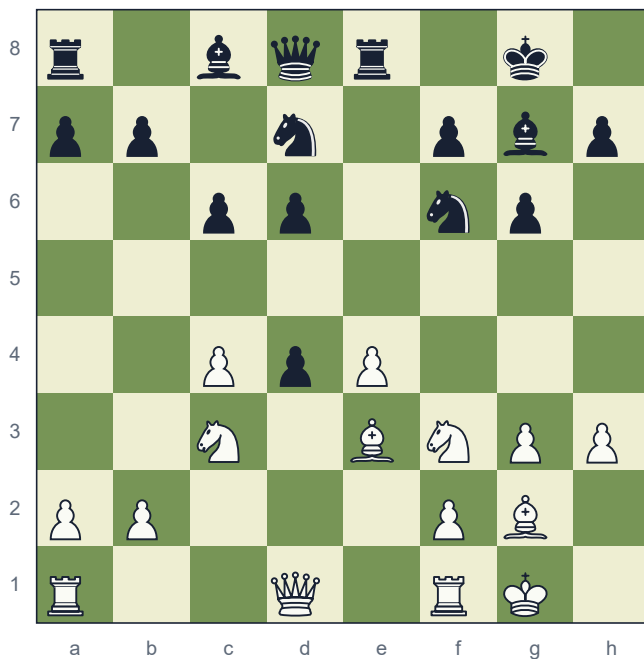
Develop the b1 knight, castle if useful, and use central squares. Aim for activity rather than spending tempi chasing the king.

WATCH FOR

Do not overvalue the loss of castling when queens are off; an active central king may become an asset.

REMEMBER Simplification changes what king safety means.

Review before your next game



Main-line study position - White to move

1. IDENTIFY THE STRUCTURE.

Black concedes central space and strikes with ...e5 or ...c5. The g2 bishop helps defend your king and adds central pressure, but its diagonal can be blocked by your own pawns.

2. NAME BLACK'S PLAN.

Black seeks ...e5, ...c5, and sometimes a queenside ...a6/...b5 expansion. ...f5 becomes relevant only when the knight and pawn structure permit it.

3. CHOOSE YOUR NEXT JOB.

Choose Qc2, Re1 or d5 according to Black's regrouping. If the center closes, identify useful knight routes rather than launching pawns immediately.

RECONSTRUCTION DRILL

Set up the starting position and play the main study line without looking. After each Black move, say what changed. If you cannot explain your reply, stop at that position and review the relevant line page.

DECISION DRILL

Return to the diagram. Write two candidate moves and a likely reply to each. You are not trying to guess the next engine move: you are testing whether your choices fit the structure and survive checks, captures and threats.

SELF-CHECK

Can you identify every capture and recapture in the line? Can you state one move-order exception? Can you explain the final position without using the opening name?

Related practice: Booklet 24. Use the matching line ID in the PGN companion. Opening names: Lichess public opening dataset; original course choices and analysis, checked with Stockfish 18.